Jothi Tutor Development Standards

TUTOR COMPETENCY FRAMEWORK

A structured framework for developing, observing, and recognising high-quality academic tutoring within the Jothi Tutor Academy

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Purpose of the Document

This document defines the tutor competency framework used within the Jothi Tutor Academy. Its purpose is to identify the core teaching competencies tutors are expected to develop, demonstrate, and strengthen as they progress through the academy.

The framework gives the academy a shared language for tutor development. It helps tutors understand what strong teaching consists of in practice, helps mentors observe and coach in a more consistent way, and supports competency sign-off and certification decisions with clearer evidence.

This document is not intended as a theoretical list detached from real teaching. It is a practical developmental framework rooted in the academy's lesson model, teaching standards, and mentor observation process.

Intended Audience

This document is intended for:

- tutors progressing through the Jothi Tutor Academy
- mentors responsible for coaching, observation, and developmental judgement
- academy leadership overseeing tutor training, readiness, and certification

Related JTA Documents

- JF03 — The 4T Teaching Engine
- JTS01 — Lesson Delivery Standard
- JTD02 — Tutor Lesson Reflection Standard

- JTD03 — Tutor Residency Progress Framework
- JTD04 — Mentor Observation Standard
- JTD06 — Tutor Certification and Sign-Off Standard

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1. Purpose of the Competency Framework

The Jothi Tutor Academy is designed to develop tutors through a structured process rather than through informal experience alone. For that process to work well, the academy needs a clear definition of what tutors are actually expected to become competent in.

The competency framework provides that definition.

It identifies the teaching skills, professional behaviours, and developmental expectations that tutors should demonstrate over time. In doing so, it prevents tutor development from becoming vague or overly impressionistic. It also makes mentor feedback more consistent, because tutors can be coached against shared instructional expectations rather than personal preference alone.

2. Relationship to the Jothi Teaching Model

The competency framework is closely linked to the wider JTA system.

- The **Jothi Trifecta** provides the philosophical foundation for teaching and learning.
- The **4T Teaching Engine** provides the instructional model used in lessons.
- The **JTS series** defines the operational teaching standards tutors are expected to follow.

- The **JTD series** defines how tutors are developed, observed, and certified.

Within this wider structure, the competency framework defines what a tutor must be able to do in order to teach effectively and consistently within the Jothi model.

The competencies are therefore not separate from the teaching system. They are the developmental expression of it.

3. Principles of the Competency Framework

The framework is guided by the following principles:

- competencies should be observable in live teaching
- development should be progressive, not assumed
- strong teaching includes both instructional skill and professional conduct
- mentor judgement should be informed by shared criteria
- competency recognition should be based on evidence, not impression alone

The purpose of the framework is not to reduce teaching to a checklist. Its purpose is to make developmental expectations clearer and more reliable.

4. Structure of the Framework

The competency framework is organised into three levels:

- **JCT1 — Core Teaching Competencies**
- **JCT2 — Developing Teaching Competencies**

- **JCT3 — Advanced Teaching Competencies**

These levels reflect increasing maturity and consistency in teaching practice. They should not be treated as rigid status labels. Their purpose is to describe a developmental pathway through which tutors move from foundational teaching behaviours toward stronger instructional judgement and wider professional contribution.

A tutor is not expected to demonstrate every competency at once. Competencies are built progressively through observation, practice, mentor feedback, reflection, and repeated live teaching.

5. External Reference Note

This competency framework is informed by the Initial Teacher Training and Early Career Framework (ITTECF) and aligned to the Teachers' Standards, while being adapted for the Jothi Tutor Academy context.

External alignment is used to strengthen clarity and professional credibility. Competency wording and sign-off judgement remain rooted in the Jothi teaching model, especially the 4T Teaching Engine, the JTS teaching standards, and the academy's mentor-led development process.

6. Interpretation Rule

Core competencies describe reliable live lesson behaviours.
Developing competencies describe stronger diagnosis, adaptation, and instructional control.
Advanced competencies describe sustained clarity, foresight, sequencing, and wider professional contribution.

7. JCT1 — Core Teaching Competencies

Core competencies are the foundational teaching behaviours expected of tutors in the earlier stages of development. These competencies describe what a tutor must

be able to do reliably within a live lesson in order to teach clearly, interact meaningfully with students, and operate within the Jothi teaching model.

Each core competency is defined as a distinct teaching function. They should not be interpreted as broad personal qualities.

C1. Explaining concepts clearly

The tutor explains a concept step by step in a way the student can follow, using clear sequencing, understandable language, and visible reasoning.

C2. Asking diagnostic questions

The tutor asks questions that check whether the student has genuinely understood the explanation, rather than relying on surface confirmation or short-answer correctness alone.

C3. Monitoring student thinking

The tutor notices and interprets evidence of the student's understanding during the lesson by attending to responses, written work, hesitation, confusion, and error patterns.

C4. Correcting misconceptions

The tutor responds to misunderstanding by identifying the visible error and guiding the student toward a more accurate understanding, rather than only supplying the answer.

C5. Structuring lessons clearly

The tutor keeps a single lesson logically organised from explanation to checking to practice, so the lesson feels coherent rather than fragmented or improvised.

C6. Using the digital board effectively

The tutor uses the digital board or writing surface in a way that makes reasoning visible, readable, and easy for the student to follow.

C7. Encouraging student reasoning

The tutor prompts the student to explain, justify, and verbalise their thinking so that reasoning becomes visible and can be strengthened or corrected.

C8. Maintaining student engagement

The tutor keeps the student mentally involved in the lesson through questioning, participation, practice, and active response, rather than allowing long passive stretches.

C9. Communicating clearly with students

The tutor speaks clearly, gives understandable instructions, and maintains a learning-focused tone that supports attention, clarity, and confidence.

C10. Maintaining professional teaching conduct

The tutor demonstrates baseline professionalism through punctuality, preparation, reliability, appropriate conduct, and readiness to teach within academy expectations.

8. JCT2 — Developing Teaching Competencies

Developing competencies reflect a stronger level of instructional judgement, adaptability, and control. At this level, the tutor is not only delivering lessons competently, but responding more intelligently to difficulty, variation, and student need.

These competencies should be interpreted as extensions of core practice, not merely stronger versions of the same wording.

D1. Diagnosing student misconceptions with accuracy

The tutor identifies the likely reason for a student’s misunderstanding, rather than only noticing that an answer is wrong.

D2. Adapting explanation to student need

The tutor changes the explanation, example, representation, or pace when the first explanation has not worked for the student.

D3. Guiding students through complex problems

The tutor supports the student through more demanding problems while preserving the student's thinking role and avoiding premature takeover.

D4. Promoting independent problem solving

The tutor gradually reduces scaffolding and support so that the student can solve more of the work independently and with increasing confidence.

D5. Using examples strategically

The tutor selects, sequences, or contrasts examples in a way that improves conceptual understanding and draws attention to important differences or patterns.

D6. Managing lesson pacing effectively

The tutor adjusts the pace of explanation, questioning, and practice so that the lesson remains purposeful without becoming rushed, overloaded, or slow to the point of drift.

D7. Encouraging student reflection

The tutor prompts the student to reflect on errors, methods, choices, and improvement after work has been completed, rather than only receiving correction passively.

D8. Connecting concepts across topics

The tutor helps the student see how ideas connect across lessons or topics so learning becomes more integrated and less isolated.

D9. Supporting examination preparation

The tutor helps the student apply understanding in exam-style conditions through disciplined written method, question interpretation, and appropriate exam technique where relevant.

D10. Monitoring student progress systematically

The tutor uses recurring assessment evidence, lesson patterns, and visible student performance over time to build an accurate picture of progress, insecurity, and readiness for next steps.

9. JCT3 — Advanced Teaching Competencies

Advanced competencies reflect a higher level of maturity, consistency, foresight, and contribution. At this level, the tutor is expected not only to teach well in the moment, but to sustain strong teaching across more complex situations and contribute more broadly to academy quality.

These competencies usually require repeated evidence over time.

A1. Designing structured lesson sequences

The tutor plans learning across multiple lessons so that ideas build cumulatively, dependencies are handled properly, and students are moved forward through a coherent sequence rather than isolated sessions.

A2. Anticipating common misconceptions

The tutor predicts likely misconceptions in advance and plans teaching, examples, questions, or comparisons to reduce those misunderstandings before they take hold.

A3. Coaching students in advanced reasoning

The tutor supports students through more demanding analytical, abstract, or multi-step reasoning while maintaining clarity, structure, and intellectual challenge.

A4. Supporting long-term student progress

The tutor sustains academic development over time by linking lesson decisions, assessment evidence, revision priorities, and student habits to longer-term outcomes rather than short-term completion alone.

A5. Integrating assessment into teaching

The tutor uses assessment naturally within teaching so that checking understanding, interpreting evidence, and adapting instruction are embedded in the lesson rather than treated as separate events.

A6. Sustaining high instructional clarity across complex teaching

The tutor maintains clarity even when teaching difficult content, layered reasoning, mixed-attainment groups, or extended problem solving, without losing structure or intelligibility.

A7. Modelling effective problem-solving strategies

The tutor explicitly models disciplined, transferable approaches to unfamiliar or demanding questions so that students learn how to think through problems, not only how to complete one example.

A8. Mentoring junior tutors

Where relevant, the tutor supports the development of less experienced tutors by modelling strong practice, giving grounded feedback, and reinforcing academy standards in a constructive way.

A9. Maintaining high professional teaching standards

The tutor sustains strong professionalism, reliability, instructional maturity, and academy-standard conduct across repeated teaching responsibility and wider contribution.

A10. Contributing to teaching improvement within the academy

The tutor contributes positively to instructional quality across the academy through resource improvement, shared practice, mentoring support, standard-setting, or other professional contribution beyond their own classroom.

10. How Competencies Should Be Interpreted

Competencies should be interpreted as live teaching capabilities, not abstract labels. They should be judged by repeated observable evidence across real lessons.

This means that competencies should not normally be signed off on the basis of:

- one isolated strong moment
- tutor self-report alone
- general positive impression without lesson evidence

Instead, competencies should be judged through patterns of demonstrated teaching behaviour over time.

11. Important Distinction for Mentors

Competencies should be signed off on the basis of repeated observable evidence. Where two competencies appear related, mentors should judge the specific teaching function being demonstrated, not the general impression of “good teaching.”

For example:

- **C3 Monitoring student thinking** is about noticing and interpreting evidence of understanding.
- **C7 Encouraging student reasoning** is about prompting the student to articulate that reasoning.

- **D1 Diagnosing misconceptions** is about identifying the likely cause of misunderstanding.

- **A2 Anticipating common misconceptions** is about planning ahead before misunderstanding appears.

This distinction matters because the framework is intended to support clear sign-off decisions rather than vague overall praise.

12. Relationship to Residency Progress

Competency development takes place across the tutor residency pathway.

- In early residency, tutors begin developing core competencies through observation and supported practice.

- In middle stages, tutors strengthen developing competencies through lead teaching and feedback.

- In later stages, tutors demonstrate increasing consistency, independence, and readiness for certification.

The competency framework and the residency framework are therefore closely connected, but they are not identical. Residency describes the developmental pathway. Competencies describe what the tutor is becoming able to do within that pathway.

13. Relationship to Reflection, Observation, and Certification

The competency framework supports several other parts of the JTA system.

Tutor reflection

JTD02 helps tutors reflect on which teaching skills they are using well and which they need to improve.

Mentor observation

JTD04 allows mentors to observe live evidence of competency development and provide feedback against real teaching behaviour.

Certification

JTD06 uses accumulated competency evidence as part of the decision about whether a tutor is ready for independent teaching.

This framework therefore acts as a bridge between day-to-day teaching and the academy's formal development process.

14. Evidence of Competency Development

Evidence of competency development may come from:

- live teaching observation
- lesson reflection
- repeated demonstration across lessons
- assessment-informed teaching decisions
- visible improvement in clarity, questioning, monitoring, and correction
- mentor judgement supported by concrete examples

Competency recognition should remain evidence-based, developmental, and proportionate.

15. Common Misuse Risks

The competency framework should be used carefully. The following misuses should be avoided:

- treating competencies as a tick-box exercise
- assuming that subject knowledge alone proves teaching competence
- signing off competencies too early without repeated evidence
- using the framework as a vague impression list rather than a developmental tool
- ignoring the difference between residency stage and actual teaching competence

These risks weaken the credibility of the framework and reduce its developmental value.

16. Relationship to the Wider JTA System

This document helps hold the wider JTA system together by defining what good teaching competence looks like in developmental terms.

It is closely connected to:

- JF03, because the 4T model shapes the kind of competencies tutors must develop
- JTS01, because lesson delivery is one of the main places competency becomes visible
- JTD03, because residency progression should be informed by competency development

- JTD04, because mentor observation is a major source of competency evidence

- JTD06, because certification depends in part on demonstrated competence

The framework therefore gives the academy a consistent basis for developmental judgement.

17. Conclusion

The Tutor Competency Framework provides the Jothi Tutor Academy with a structured way to define, observe, and develop high-quality academic tutoring. It ensures that tutor development is based on real teaching capability rather than assumption, confidence, or subject knowledge alone.

Its purpose is not to reduce teaching to a checklist, but to make professional growth clearer, more evidence-based, and more consistent across the academy.